

MINUTES
VANCE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS
BUDGET WORK SESSION
May 20, 2025

The Vance County Board of Commissioners held a budget work session on Tuesday, May 20, 2025 at 4:00 p.m. in the Commissioners' Conference Room, Vance County Administration Building, 122 Young Street, Henderson, NC. Those commissioners present were as follows: Chair Carolyn Faines, Vice-Chair Yolanda J. Feimster, Commissioners R. Dan Brummitt, Charisse Fain, Leo Kelly, Jr., and Valencia Perry.

Absent: Commissioner Thomas S. Hester, Jr.

Also present were County Manager C. Renee Perry, Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones, Finance Director Stephanie Williams, and Special Projects Coordinator Frankie Nobles.

The purpose of the work session was to review and discuss the proposed budget for FY 2025-26.

Staff provided a summary of revenues, expenditures and unfunded requests from county departments and outside agencies. County Manager C. Renee Perry noted that the budget does not include an increase or decrease in the tax rate or fire tax rate. Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt expressed his displeasure that the budget does not include a decrease in the tax rate.

The board discussed the school budget. Ms. Perry noted that the budget does include an increase in the teacher supplement from \$2,500 to \$3,000 and a 1% increase for classified staff.

The board discussed the increased costs of audit requirements for volunteer fire departments. Currently, the county reimburses the department \$2,000 for completed audit/financial reviews. It was noted that current pricing can be as much as \$6,000. Ms. Perry stated that the fire association may want to modify their contracts to perform "compilation reviews" on years one and two, and an "audit review" on the third year. Compilation reviews are less expensive.

Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt questioned the balance of the Kerr Lake Substation loan and was told it is \$10,300. The proposed budget was corrected to reflect this amount instead of the annual payment of \$33,900.

Ms. Perry asked the board if they would like to create a separate capital reserve account for jail construction. She recommends USDA financing for this project. Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt expressed his concerns with spending taxpayer dollars for a new jail. No decision was made on this matter.

The board discussed roof repairs for the Eaton Johnson gym, vocational building, and kitchen. There was also discussion about moving the county's maintenance department to the vocational building. Roof repair for the gym can be deferred until next year.

Ms. Perry again provided a summary of notable unfunded requests. Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt questioned a request from social services for an IT Compliance Administrator position. Ms. Perry stated that she has not received this request but will research this matter.

Ms. Perry noted that Granville County has been putting aside capital reserve funding for the community college for the past few years. Vance County has not. Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt asked staff to check and see if there is still a state bond bill available to help with this. He also stated that he would like to see a list of needs before making a decision on this matter.

Ms. Perry recommended a gate be installed to the parking lot beside the administration building to be used by staff that are housed in the administration building. Following discussion, staff will do an assessment of the proposed gate.

Ms. Perry informed the board that the city performed a water rate study and proposes to increase its water rate by 32% effective July 1, and an additional increase of 5.4% in 2027.

The board discussed the solid waste budget and the household fee.

Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt expressed his concerns with salary compression. Following discussion, Ms. Perry stated that she would reach out to the company that performed the salary study to appear before the board to answer any questions they may have.

Ms. Perry stated that she is recommending that the city reimburse the county 30% of the code enforcement budget for inspections inside the city limits. This is contingent upon an interlocal agreement with the city.

Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt expressed his displeasure with the process of the budget work session. He would like to address the budget department-by-department, line-by-line. Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr. stated that he was pleased with the process. If commissioners have specific questions, they can call and meet with staff. Chair Faines agreed.

The next work session was scheduled for Monday, June 16 at 4:00 p.m.

Board of Equalization and Review meetings were scheduled for Tuesday, June 3, 2025 at 1:00 p.m. and Tuesday, June 17, 2025 at 1:00 p.m.

As there was no further business, the work session was adjourned.